A FIELD GUIDE FOR PRE-BOOKED BUSINESSES · GOA

BOOKING EFFICIENCY · VOL. 1

Every empty chair costs you twice.

Once in the money you didn't make, and again in the hour your team spent trying to fill it. Here is what a cancellation really costs, and five ways to win the slot back.

SATURDAY · CHAIR 2

1 CANCELLATION · 11:42 PM LAST NIGHT

10:00	11:00	12:00	13:00	14:00	15:00	16:00	17:00	18:00	19:00
Meera K. Root canal review	**Arjun P.** Physio · knee	**Sana D.** Gel extensions	**Lunch** Team break	CANCELLED **Hydrafacial · ₹3,500**	**Rohan F.** Laser · session 4	**Priya N.** Colour + gloss	**Leon M.** Sports rehab	**Kavya R.** Scaling	**Close** Clean-up

Booked `8 / 9` Lost if unfilled `₹3,500` Notice given `under 15 hrs`

09:00 · THE FACTS

It isn't rare. It's every week.

From a 2025 survey of 200+ beauty and wellness businesses and 500 of their clients.

47%

of businesses get short-notice cancellations or no-shows **every single week**.

62%

of clients who cancel give **less than 24 hours' notice**, too late to refill by phone.

~7%

of monthly revenue is lost on average. **1 in 7** businesses lose 11–20%.

Source: Fresha, "The Hidden Cost of Cancellations", Dec 2025. Survey of UK businesses; we're collecting the Goa numbers now.

10:30 · YOUR NUMBER

What it costs you.

Move the sliders to match last week. Everything stays on your screen; nothing is saved or sent.

Short-notice gaps per week 3

Average appointment value ₹1,500

Share you could refill 50%

LOST EVERY MONTH

₹19,350

Lost every year	₹2,32,200
Won back if you refill	₹9,675 / mo
Hours of empty chair / year	156

Gaps × value × 4.3 weeks. Hours assume 1-hour appointments.

12:00 · WHERE IT BREAKS

Four moments that empty the diary.

Every owner we've spoken to recognises at least two of these.

23:42 · The night-before text

"Sorry, can't make it tomorrow."

It arrives when you're asleep. By the time you read it, the morning is already here and the slot is hard to sell.

14:10 · The silent no-show

Nobody comes. Nobody calls.

Your therapist waits 10 minutes, then 20. The hour is gone, and so is the client who wanted it.

09:15 · The phone-around

Reception calls six people.

Two don't pick up, three can't make it, one says maybe. Forty minutes of staff time for an empty chair.

All week · The lost list

"Let me know if anything opens."

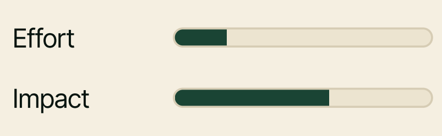
Clients ask to be squeezed in all the time. Their names end up in a chat thread, a notebook, or nowhere.

15:00 · THE FIXES

Five ways to win the slot back.

Start with the first two today; they're free. The fifth one closes the gap the others leave open.

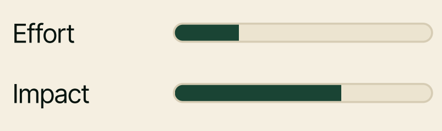
1 Confirm the day before



Send a WhatsApp 24 hours ahead asking clients to reply YES. People who won't come usually say so when asked, which turns a no-show into a slot you can still sell.

"Hi Meera, your appointment is tomorrow at 10:00. Reply YES to confirm, or tell us if you need to move it."

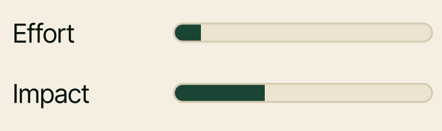
2 Keep a real waiting list



Every time a client asks for an earlier slot, write down their name, number and the times they can do. It's the single most valuable list in a booked-out business.

One shared note or sheet is enough to start. What matters is that it exists before the cancellation does.

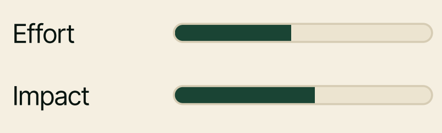
3 Say your policy out loud



One line on every confirmation changes behaviour without upsetting anyone: "Please give us 24 hours' notice so we can offer your slot to someone waiting."

It reframes cancelling as fairness to other clients, not a rule you enforce.

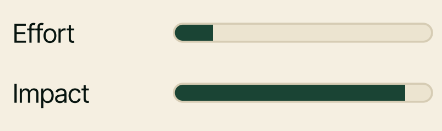
4 Take a deposit on the long ones



For treatments over an hour or above ₹2,000, a small advance shows commitment and covers part of the loss if they don't come.

Keep it optional for regulars you trust. Use it for first-timers and big-ticket sessions.

5 Refill automatically, in minutes



Fixes 1 to 4 reduce cancellations. None of them fill the slot once it's empty. The fastest businesses offer the opening to everyone on the waiting list at once, and the first person to tap gets it.

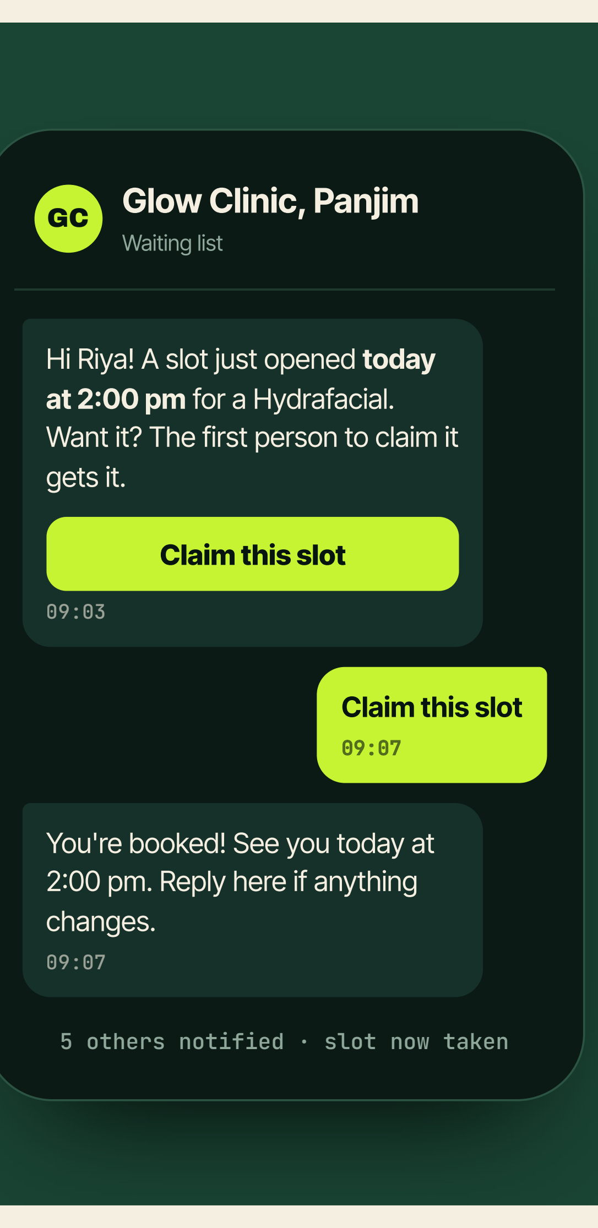
This is how busy clinics abroad recover hours that used to be lost. See how it works below.

FIX 5, UP CLOSE

The slot fills itself before lunch.

09:02	A client cancels the 2:00 pm Hydrafacial.
09:03	The opening goes out on WhatsApp to six waiting-list clients who said 2 pm works.
09:07	Riya taps **Claim** first. The slot is hers; everyone else sees it's taken.
09:07	Your diary updates. Nobody on your team picked up a phone.

Phone-around: about 40 minutes, if it works at all. Automatic: about 5 minutes, while you get on with your day.



Glow Clinic, Panjim

Waiting list

Hi Riya! A slot just opened **today at 2:00 pm** for a Hydrafacial. Want it? The first person to claim it gets it.

09:03

Claim this slot

09:07

You're booked! See you today at 2:00 pm. Reply here if anything changes.

09:07

5 others notified · slot now taken

18:00 · THIS WEEK

Start before Friday.

One small step a day. Tick them off as you go; the ticks stay only on this device.

MON

☐ Count last week's short-notice cancellations and no-shows.

TUE

☐ Start a waiting list. Add everyone who asked for an earlier slot this month.

WED

☐ Send day-before confirmations for every appointment.

THU

☐ Add your 24-hour policy line to every booking message.

FRI

☐ Next cancellation: message the whole waiting list at once and time how fast it fills.

The Empty Chair Guide · Part of a study of pre-booked businesses in Goa, by Atreya.

Questions or want the full Goa report? Reply to the message this came in.